The Means of Accomplishing Hevajra, Called Illuminating Reality

Hevajrasādhana Tattvoddyotakara · Toh 1253 · Derge Tengyur

དཀྱེ་པའི་རྡོ་རྗེ་སྒྲུབ་པའི་ཐབས་དེ་ཁོ་ནོ་ཉིད་གསལ་བར་བྱེད་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་བ།

The Means of Accomplishing Hevajra, Called Illuminating Reality, known in Sanskrit as the Hevajrasādhana Tattvoddyotakara and in Tibetan as Dgyes pa'i rdo rje sgrub pa'i thabs de kho na nyid gsal bar byed pa, is a sādhana, a manual for the meditative practice of the tantric deity Hevajra, composed by the Indian master Kṛṣṇapāda, also known as Kāṇha. Opening with homage to Mañjuśrī, to Hevajra embraced by his consort and encircled by goddesses, and to the author's guru Samayavajra, it sets out the practice of generating oneself as Hevajra out of compassion for sentient beings, and it goes on to explain the symbolic purity of every element of the visualization: the deity's ornaments and implements, the eight goddesses and their emblems, the palace of the maṇḍala, and the eight charnel grounds, each correlated with a point of Buddhist doctrine such as the aggregates, the four immeasurables, the eightfold path and the five powers. The work is Toh 1253 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the Tantra commentaries section among the texts of the Hevajra cycle, and according to its colophon it was translated into Tibetan by the brahmin scholar Kṛṣṇa together with the monk Tsultrim Gyalwa.

In the language of India: hevajrasādhanaṃ tattva otyot takaranāma. In the language of Tibet: The Means of Accomplishing Hevajra, Called Illuminating Reality.

Homage to Mañjuśrī in youthful form.

oṃ Homage to Hevajra.

Magical display, illusion-like in substance, from the essence examined as one and many,
whose body, like a cloud at the time of the world's destruction, is embraced by supreme Wisdom,
encircled by goddesses emanated through the pure reality arisen from the vajra,
bearing a form made wrathful by compassion: to Hevajra I always pay homage.

To the vajra holder
by whom the fruit, the mind of the glorious Blood Drinker (Heruka),
is made clear, the guru,
Samayavajra, I pay homage.

First of all, one takes as one's object the realm of sentient beings, who have grown weary under the harm of suffering in its many forms. With a mind wholly governed by and filled with the savor of surpassing compassion, one has cultivated the ten perfections, beginning with generosity, and so possesses a purified mental continuum. One has received empowerment and permission in the maṇḍala of glorious Hevajra, and is a yogin skilled in the pledges and the conduct. Such a yogin should rise at dawn and imagine in his own heart, upon a sun maṇḍala arisen from repha, the supreme first syllable hūṃ. Staying in some pleasing place, such as a charnel ground, he sits on a comfortable seat and, endowed with the mudrā of meditative absorption, with a hook of light rays arising from the syllable hūṃ, he summons the Blessed One, with the color, arms and weapons that will be described, and, looking toward the sky, worships him with offerings of mentally produced flowers and the like. Then he should make offering with the five qualities of sense pleasure through the goddesses Gaurī and the rest, who arise from the seed in his heart.

Among them, Gaurī holds in her hand a skull cup marked with a deer. Caurī has her hands occupied with a vessel filled with self-arisen flowers. Vetālī has her second hand occupied with a vessel of water. Ghasmarī carries a vessel filled with meat. Pukkasī carries in her hand a vessel filled with sandalwood. Śavarī pours honey from a vessel. Caṇḍālī beats a small hand drum and makes offering. Ḍombī embraces him about the neck and unites with him in union.

Then, before that very Blessed One, he should confess his misdeeds and so on, saying: "I confess each and every one of my misdeeds. I rejoice in the merit of the buddhas, the bodhisattvas and all ordinary people. Until I reach the heart of awakening, I go for refuge to the Buddha Vajradhara, endowed with great compassion, to the entire Dharma of the Great Vehicle, and to the Saṅgha of irreversible bodhisattvas and the host of goddesses. I shall generate the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, in order to bring about the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, and to establish them, for as long as it takes, in the ultimate nirvāṇa, the awakening of a buddha. That is to say, I shall rely on this very path of the unsurpassed Great Vehicle. I offer my very self to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas. And I dedicate all these roots of

virtue to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening." Having said this and paid homage, he also gives a torma and pleases the deity by reciting the hundred-syllable mantra: oṃ śrī heruka samaya manupālaya heruka tveno patiṣṭha dṛḍho me bhava anurakto me bhava sutoṣyo me bhava supoṣyo me bhava sarvva siddhi mme prayaccha sarvva karmma su ca me cittaṃ śriyaḥ kuru hūṃ ha ha ha ha hoḥ bhagavāna heruka mame muñca herukva bhava mahā samaya satva āḥ hūṃ phaṭ vajra muḥ. With this he requests the deity to depart.

Then he should cultivate loving-kindness, characterized by equal regard for all sentient beings, as for a beloved only child; compassion, characterized by the wish to turn those very beings back from suffering and the causes of suffering; joy, which delights in accomplishing and producing divine happiness for those same beings; and then equanimity, which has the aspect of wishing to accomplish for them the path that has the nature of unsurpassed bliss.

Beings are empty of essential nature,
without signs and without cause;
since all is free of conceptualization,
aspirations too are wholly abandoned.
Knowing everything in this way,
this illusion-like mind of mine
is produced in its aspects by ignorance;
through the cessation of that, it will cease.

He should bless himself with the mantra oṃ śūñatā jñāna vajra svabhāva ātmako 'haṃ.

Then, for the sake of protection:

First, visualize a sun from repha;
on that sun, from hūṃ, a crossed vajra arises;
by that very vajra a fence
and a tent are fastened: visualize these as well.

The meaning of this is as follows. Light radiates from the sun and the crossed vajra, which melt and become one; from that, through further radiation, one should visualize below a ground of vajra nature, above a vajra tent, on the sides a vajra fence, and outside that a blazing vajra fire. One should also make it firm with the mantra oṃ rakṣa rakṣa hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā.

In its center one should visualize the source of phenomena, a triangular sphere of space, white like the autumn moon, whose essential nature is the wisdom of the utterly pure realm of phenomena. In its center is a blue wind maṇḍala arisen from the syllable yaṃ, shaped like a bow and marked by two fluttering banners. Above it, from repha, is a red triangular fire maṇḍala, marked at its corners with the syllable raṃ. Above it is a round water maṇḍala arisen from vaṃ, white in color and marked with a vase. Above it one should visualize a yellow square earth maṇḍala arisen from laṃ, marked at its corners with vajras. There the meditator himself definitively abides as that which makes manifest the distinctive quality of transcendent wisdom.

Then, inside the source of phenomena, from the transformation of the four great elements, arises a crossed vajra upon a multicolored lotus; at the hub of that crossed vajra is the city of great liberation, the celestial palace whose essence is Vairocana and whose nature is that of many kinds of jewels.

It is square, with four doors,
adorned with eight pillars,
furnished with garlands and yak-tail whisks of many kinds,
and ornamented with vajra lines.
With the tips of many fluttering banners,
resounding with bells and tinkling chimes,
it is adorned with requisites
possessing the supreme qualities of sense pleasure.
It is beautified with full and half necklaces
and with four porticos;
it is set with jewels
and adorned with garlands along its parapets.
On the frieze of figures, twice eight
offering goddesses make offering.
The lute goddess, holding her lute aloft, is blue;
the song goddess and the flute goddess are yellow;
the dance goddess and the drum goddess are green;
the laughter goddess and the clay-drum goddess are white and red.
The dance goddess whirls her hands;
the song goddess has cymbals.
The incense goddess is blue, the flower goddess white;
the lamp goddess is like the light of a lamp;
the scent goddess and the taste goddess are red in color;

the touch goddess and the mirror goddess are green;
the Dharma goddess is white, with her own emblem.
All of them have two arms.

Outside are the terrifying charnel grounds,
right within the vajra fence:
Fierce and Violent, the Dense,
likewise Garland of Flames,
and the Terrifying One with Skulls,
in order from the east, going to the left;
Aṭṭahāsa, Loud Laughter, in Īśāna's quarter;
the Forest of the Lord in the quarter of fire;
Ghorāndhakāra, Terrifying Darkness, in Nairṛti's;
and in the Wind's quarter, Kilikilārava.
Śirīṣa, aśva, kaṅkeli
and the cūta tree, from the east onward in order;
the great tree, and karañja,
the creeper-clad tree, and arjuna.
Indra, Kubera, the Noose Holder,
and the king of Yama's quarter are held to be in the directions;
Īśāna in the intermediate quarter, and the Fire Eater,
the lord of rākṣasas, and the Wind.
Vāsuki's son and Takṣaka,
Karkoṭa and Padma,
Mahāpadma, Hulunta,
Kulika and Śaṅkhapāla.
Thunderer, Whirler, Terrible,
Turner, and Dense,
Filler and Rain Pourer,
and Fierce: these in order are the lords of the clouds.

Among them, Śakra (Indra) rides an elephant; he is yellow in color, and in his left hand he holds a skull cup marked with a vajra. Kubera rides a yakṣa; he is yellow in color, a pot-bellied dwarf, holding in his left hand a skull cup and a club. Varuṇa rides a makara; he is white in color, adorned with ornaments of snakes, and holds in his left hand a skull cup and a noose. Yama rides a buffalo; he is blue in color, pot-bellied, with yellow hair standing on end, in the form of a dwarf, holding in his left hand a skull cup and a staff. Īśāna rides a

bull; he has three eyes, is white in color, and holds in his left hand a skull cup and a spear. Agni, the Fire Eater, rides a goat; he is reddish yellow in color, four-armed, with yellow hair, and holds a triple staff, a skull cup and a rosary. The lord of rākṣasas rides a corpse; he has the form of a dwarf, is blue in color, with yellow hair blazing upward, pot-bellied, holding in his left hand a sword and a skull cup. The lord of wind is blue in color, rides a deer, has a peaceful face, and holds a banner. All these world protectors have their own colors, seats and emblems, and all of them pay homage to the Blessed One with their right hands. The colors of the clouds are like those of the world protectors. The nāgas dwell upon them, all with palms joined.

The field protectors who dwell in the eight trees have faces like the mounts of the eight protectors of the directions, with reddish yellow hair standing on end. The one who dwells in the śiriṣa is called the Assembly of Gods, white in color. The one who dwells in the cūta tree is called Yama, blue in color. The one who dwells in the aśvaka is called the King of Clouds, red in color. The one who dwells in the bodhi tree is called the Leader of the Yakṣa Hosts, yellow in color. The one who dwells in the karañja tree is called the Gathering of Sages, red. The one who dwells in the creeper-clad tree is the one with the host of rākṣasas, blue in color. The one who dwells in the arjuna is called the King of Wind, green in color. The one who dwells in the great tree is called the Gathering of Pretas; he should be seen as smoke-colored.

The charnel grounds of the eight directions should be seen with beheaded corpses, hanged corpses, corpses laid out, corpses impaled on stakes, heads, skeletons, carcasses of oxen, crows and owls, vultures and vetālas, all uttering the sound phaṭ, every one of them just as discerned by the accomplished ones of old. They should be seen adorned by yakṣas, rākṣasas, pretas, piśācas, bringers of madness, bringers of forgetfulness, grahas, ḍākas and ḍākinīs, and together with practitioners.

The lotus at its heart:

With petals of many colors and with anthers;
at the four doors and the four corners,
moons upon multicolored lotuses;
Brahmā, Indra, Upendra (Viṣṇu), Rudra,
Yama, likewise the lord of yakṣas,
Nairṛti and Vemacitrin;
in the center, the four māras,

dwelling at the center of a sun maṇḍala,
their hearts pressed down, they who are so terrifying.

On the central seat, from the fifteen vowel letters, arises a moon maṇḍala, whose essential nature is mirror-like wisdom. Above it, from the thirty-four consonant letters, arises a sun maṇḍala, whose essential nature is the wisdom of equality. In its center, from the transformation of the syllables aṃ and hūṃ, arise a curved knife and a skull cup joined face to face, with their own seeds at their heart, whose essential nature is discriminating wisdom. From these, tathāgatas who are emanations of countless families of yoginīs radiate forth, and after making beings into the nature of buddhas, they gather back into that very place and become one: this is the essential nature of the wisdom that accomplishes activities. Then, arising from the complete transformation of the moon, the sun, the emblem and the seed, one should meditate on the Blessed One Vajrasattva, with the color, shape, arms and weapons that will be described, embraced by his self-appearing consort, whose essential nature is the wisdom of the utterly pure realm of phenomena. This is the fivefold manifest awakening.

Then one should see in the sky the syllables aṃ and hūṃ, each supported by two syllables hoḥ, and, having duly summoned them with sounds of great delight, one should meditate that they enter by the mouth of the Blessed One and fall into the lotus of the Blessed Lady. Then the Blessed One together with the Blessed Lady melts in the fire of great passion, and one should see this as a maṇḍala in the form of melted awakening mind. Then, in order to raise him up, the four goddesses, Pukkasī and the others, come from their own directions, sit on seats in their own directions, and urge him with four verses:

Arise, you whose mind is saving compassion!
Protect me, Pukkasī!
Abandon the very nature of emptiness,
and consent to join with me in great bliss.

Without you here I shall die,
so arise, Hevajra!
Abandon the very nature of emptiness,
and bring to fulfillment the fruit for Śavarī.

Lord of joy, host of the world,
why do you abide in emptiness?

Without you I know no direction;
I, Caṇḍālī, make my plea.

Since I know your mind,
you who possess magical display, arise!
I, Ḍombī, am skillful;
do not cut off the stream of your compassion.

Then, the instant he is urged, he melts into a moon, and from that there are, at the center of the curved knife and skull cup upon the moon and sun maṇḍalas, those very same two seeds. Through a process of radiation from them, in the form of a wheel of yoginīs, the aims of beings are accomplished, and they are gathered back into those seeds; then, from the complete transformation of the moon, the sun, the seed and the emblem, one should meditate on oneself as the second form of glorious Heruka, which arises from them.

Stamping his feet upon the ground,
he menaces the gods and the asuras.
Wrathful, with eyes red and round,
his form is youthful and full of vigor.
He has eight faces and sixteen arms,
and strides with four legs,
trampling the four māras all alike.
His head is adorned with a garland of skulls;
his terrifying body is smeared with ashes;
he stands in the dancing posture of half-crossed legs.
His root face is deep black;
the right is like the white jasmine;
the left is deep red and most terrifying;
the upper one is smoke-colored and contorted;
the remaining faces are like bees,
and each one has three eyes.
From his mouths he radiates hūṃ;
he is adorned with the five mudrās;
black in color, greatly terrifying,
his crown adorned with a crossed vajra.
Graceful, heroic, frightful,
fierce, laughing and terrifying,
compassionate, awe-inspiring and peaceful,

he has the flavors of the nine moods of dance.
His reddish yellow hair blazes upward;
he terrifies even those who terrify.
He wears a necklace that is a garland of heads,
with a radiance like the fire at the time of the world's destruction.
Elephant, horse, donkey, ox, camel,
man, śarabha and cat:
in the eight skull cups on the right,
know them in order, beginning with the twice-drinker, the elephant.
Earth, water and wind,
fire, moon and sun,
Antaka and Kubera
are in the eight skull cups on the left.
In union with him is Nairātmyā,
self-appearing, with the five mudrās,
with two arms, one face and two legs;
she holds a curved knife and a skull cup.

Then one should see, on the sun at the Blessed One's heart, upon a skull cup, the syllable hūṃ, and on the curved knife upon the moon at the Blessed Lady's heart, the syllable aṃ. At the head, on a white lotus and a moon, is oṃ. At the throat, on a red lotus and a source of phenomena, is the syllable āḥ. At the heart one should meditate on a multicolored lotus and, on a sun, the syllable hūṃ. At the eyes, on a wheel upon a moon maṇḍala, is Vajrā, white, arisen from the syllable ā. At the ears, on a sun and a vajra, is Nairātmyā, blue, arisen from aṃ. At the nose, on a sun and a jewel, is Gaurī, yellow, arisen from the syllable ī. At the tongue, on a lotus and a sun, is Vāriyoginī, red, arisen from the syllable ī. At the crown, on a crossed vajra and a sun, is Vajraḍākinī, green, arisen from the syllable ū. At the heart one should imagine, on a multicolored lotus and a vajra, Nairātmyā, white, arisen from the syllable aṃ. All these goddesses hold a skull cup and a khaṭvāṅga in the left hand and a curved knife in the right.

After that, at the navel, on a white lotus of sixty-four petals and a moon, is a white oṃ. On the eight central petals, going counterclockwise, are a ka ca ṭa ta pa ya śa. At the heart is a multicolored lotus of eight petals facing downward; on its four intermediate petals are ya ra la va, and on the four directional petals the four a i e o. At its center is the syllable hūṃ, facing

downward. At the throat is a red lotus of sixteen petals facing upward; on the four directional petals at its center, going counterclockwise, are the four ā ī ū ai, and at its hub is the syllable oṃ. At the head, at the hub of a white lotus of thirty-two petals, is the syllable haṃ, facing downward.

After that, with black light rays shaped like hooks radiating from the seed at the Blessed One's heart, one invites all the tathāgatas and, looking toward the sky, worships them fully through the eight mātṛkās. Then one should request empowerment, saying, "May all the tathāgatas grant me empowerment." Then those buddhas, great beings in the form of Heruka, bring forth countless yoginīs from themselves, and when those who embody the five tathāgatas confer empowerment with vases, a rain of flowers and a rain of saffron fall. Rūpavajrā and the other goddesses offer praise, and Buddhalocanā and the others sing vajra songs. Immediately upon the empowerment, one should think that one's head is adorned with the Victor Akṣobhya. This is called the first yoga; it is the first meditative absorption, the body of essential nature.

After that, as before, one sees oṃ at the Blessed Lady's head, hūṃ at her heart, and the syllable āḥ on the pistil of her lotus, and recites oṃ padma sukhadhara mahārāga sukhaṃdatta catura ānanda bhagaviśva hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ karyāṃ kuruṣva me. One meditates on the Blessed One's vajra arising from the syllable hūṃ, and imagines the jewel arising from oṃ and the opening arising from phaṭ. Then one should begin the delight with oṃ vajra mahādveṣa catura ānanda dāyaka khagamukha ekaraso nātha hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ karyaṃ kuruṣva me siṃ siṃ siṃ ha ha ha.

Then, urged by the sound of union, all the tathāgatas enter by the path of the mouth and melt at the heart, and by the path of the vajra they melt into a moon within the lotus. From the complete transformation of the syllable gaṃ there, Gaurī is emanated, black in color, holding a curved knife and a rohita fish. Emerging from the heart of the consort, Wisdom, she accomplishes the aims of beings, and one should see her seated on the seat at the eastern door. Likewise, from caṃ, Caurī, the color of madder, holding a small hand drum and a pig, is on the seat at the southern door. Likewise, Vetālī, arisen from vaṃ, yellow in color, holding a tortoise and a skull cup, is at the western door. Likewise, Ghasmarī, arisen from ghaṃ, green in color, holding a snake and a yogin's bowl, is at the northern door. Likewise, Pukkasī, arisen from paṃ, like a blue sapphire, holding a lion and an axe, is in the quarter of Īśāna. Likewise, Śavarī, arisen from śaṃ, white in color, holding a monk and a ringing staff, is on the seat in the quarter of fire. Likewise, Caṇḍālī, arisen from caṃ, light blue

like the sky, holding a wheel and a plough, is on the seat in the quarter of Nairṛti. Likewise, one sees Ḍombinī, arisen from ḍaṃ, of many colors, with a vajra and the threatening gesture, on the seat in the quarter of the wind.

Having viewed the maṇḍala thus complete, one summons the wisdom maṇḍala with the light rays of the seed at one's heart and, looking toward the sky in front, drives away the obstructors with the mantra of the Eight-Faced One. Then one offers water for welcoming with oṃ śrī heruka arghaṃ pratīccha svāhā, water for the feet with oṃ śrī heruka pādyaṃ pratīccha svāhā, and water for rinsing the mouth with oṃ śrī heruka añcamānaṃ. With oṃ gaurī ākarṣaya jaḥoṃ, caurī praveśaya hūṃ, oṃ vetālī bandhapaṃ and oṃ ghasmarī toṣaya hoḥ one summons them, makes them enter, binds them, and brings them under control, and then meditates on the wisdom wheel and the pledge maṇḍala as one, of a single taste. Then, having summoned the wisdom maṇḍala with the hook of light rays from the seed at one's heart and made offerings, one should request empowerment. Then one meditates that they empower oneself. On the heads of those who have been empowered are the Victors: Pukkasī and Gaurī are to be sealed by Akṣobhya, Śavarī and Caurī by Vairocana, Caṇḍālī and Vetālī by Ratnasambhava, and Ḍombinī and Ghasmarī by Amitābha.

Then, viewing the maṇḍala now complete, one should regard it as being like an illusion and like a dream. From the seed at one's heart one emanates the eight offering goddesses, and with clouds of incense from them one should make offering to the maṇḍala together with its lord. Then one should praise them oneself, as though they were directly present, with these words:

Greatly terrifying one, baring your fangs,
adorned with a garland of entrails,
you who partake of the great meat:
homage to Heruka!

Then, above the wind maṇḍala arisen from the syllable yaṃ is a fire maṇḍala from raṃ, and on it a skull cup arisen from a, in whose center are the substances, marked with oṃ. Above them is a vajra from hūṃ. From the union of vajra and lotus a fire blazes, which brings them to the boil, so that they ripen and melt. With its light rays one draws in the nectar of the seeds at the hearts of all the tathāgatas, makes them one, and consecrates it with oṃ āḥ hūṃ. One meditates that one's tongue, from the syllable hūṃ, has become a white vajra, imagines the maṇḍala wheel on the sun at one's heart, and with

that nectar one should satisfy oneself and the maṇḍala wheel.

In the delightful city of the mātṛkās
one should meditate on such a lord.
One attains a bliss without waves;
through being waveless, it is bliss itself.

This is the second, the meditative absorption of the supreme king of the maṇḍala; it is the enjoyment body.

With the light rays of the seed at one's heart, one purifies the sentient beings of the immeasurable and endless world systems into the form of glorious Heruka, summons them fully, and makes them enter the maṇḍala. The maṇḍala dissolves into oneself, oneself into the wisdom being, the wisdom being into the emblem, the emblem into the seed, and the seed into the drop; and from the drop, in an instant, one imagines it vividly in the form of the maṇḍala wheel. In this way one should emanate and gather again and again. This is the yoga of the drop, for those whose minds have grown weary.

Through the meditative absorption of great bliss one makes all the tathāgatas enter, and at the tip of the pistil of Wisdom's lotus, in the center of one's own seed, one should hold the maṇḍala wheel as placed inside a jewel the size of a mustard seed, and contemplate it; then the five signs will appear. Afterward one should emanate through the yoga of recollection: this is the subtle yoga. Thus, in an instant, by emanating hosts of countless light rays brought forth from wisdom, joined to the seeing of oneself and others, one should meditate on the whole, complete in every part, through the yoga of recollection itself.

If one grows weary of meditation, one should recite the mantra; yet one should not become attached even to the mantra. Here, joining the mind to the subtle element and making the mind steady at the tip of the nose, one should recite, combining it with the sequence of entering, abiding and emerging and with the three syllables.

Alternatively, on the sun maṇḍala at one's heart one writes with the mind the thirteen syllables, blazing like a garland of lamps, and recites them with certainty, just as the mind has written them: oṃ deva picu vajra hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā. This is called the supreme king of action; it is the third meditative absorption, the emanation body.

Then, in order to accomplish all activities, one should recite the garland mantra. One imagines that the garland mantra arises from the seed at the

heart of the one who abides in the form of the maṇḍala wheel, and one should imagine that the mantra is uttered from all his faces and from the faces of all the goddesses. If one wishes to rise, one meditates that the wheel of goddesses is absorbed into the seed at his heart, and one should meditate on the supporting maṇḍala as exceedingly vast. Then one should dedicate the merit with this verse:

Through this merit may omniscience be attained,
may the enemies, the faults, be conquered,
and may beings be delivered from the ocean of existence,
churned by the waves of aging, sickness and death.

One should also make proper aspirations:

Born into the family, keeping the pledges,
free of madness, a teacher of Hevajra,
devoted to the guru and endowed with compassion:
so may I be, birth after birth.
My hands sounding the vajra and bell,
reading this profound Dharma,
sharing as common food the fluid of the queen:
so may I be, birth after birth.

Then one should regard the sentient beings of saṃsāra as having the form of Heruka, and ascertain the four great elements as being the essence of the four, Pukkasī and the rest. In this way one should do everything with the pride of Hevajra.

In the midday session and the afternoon session too, one likewise sits on a comfortable seat and, in an instant, firmly regards oneself as having the form of Hevajra. One sees the goddesses arising from the seed at one's heart, each in her place, and performs the entry of the wisdom being, the empowerment, the offerings, the praise, the tasting of nectar, the recitation and so on.

At the time of going to sleep, the wisdom being emerges from the seed at one's heart; looking toward the sky, one worships him fully through the eight mātṛkās, and requests him to depart by reciting the hundred-syllable mantra ending with muḥ. One gathers the maṇḍala wheel into one's heart, performs the union of the limbs, regards all this variety as the essence of innate joy, and then goes to sleep. One is awakened, urged on by the songs of the four goddesses, and on rising one does everything as before. One should do this constantly, until the signs of accomplishment appear. Once one has seen

them, one should practice in accordance with the tantra.

The six-armed form is likewise. In the first left hand is a trident, in the first right a vajra, in the second left a bell, in the second right a curved knife; with the remaining two hands he embraces the consort, Wisdom. Likewise, of the four-armed form, the first right hand holds a vajra and the left a skull cup, and with the remaining two he embraces the consort. Likewise, of the two-armed form, the right hand holds a vajra and the left a skull cup, and he embraces Wisdom. One should meditate on him in the form of the lord of the maṇḍala. All these too should be meditated on in every respect like the sixteen-armed form. If one grows weary of recitation and meditation, one should firmly regard everything as utterly pure.

The sixteen arms are the emptinesses. Which are they? The emptiness of the internal, the emptiness of the external, the emptiness of the external and internal, the emptiness of emptiness, the great emptiness, the emptiness of the ultimate, the emptiness of the conditioned, the emptiness of the unconditioned, the emptiness of what is beyond extremes, the emptiness of what has neither beginning nor end, the emptiness of what is not discarded, the emptiness of nature, the emptiness of all phenomena, the emptiness of own characteristics, the emptiness of non-apprehension, the emptiness of non-entities, the emptiness of essential nature, and the emptiness of the essential nature of non-entities: these are the sixteen arms.

The four means of gathering disciples are the four legs: generosity, pleasant speech, beneficial conduct and consistency of purpose. The skin is the seven limbs of awakening. Which are they? Mindfulness, diligence, joy, pliancy, meditative absorption, equanimity, and thorough discrimination of phenomena, which are called the limbs of perfect awakening: these are the skin. The flesh is Pukkasī. The blood is Śavarī. The semen is Caṇḍālī. The fat and marrow are Ḍombinī. The bones are the Four Truths: suffering, origin, cessation and the path.

The eight faces are the eight liberations. Which are they? Seeing form as empty; seeing inner form as empty; seeing as empty the view produced by the attractive and the unattractive; seeing the sphere of infinite space as empty; seeing the sphere of infinite consciousness as empty; seeing the sphere of nothingness as empty; seeing the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception as empty; and seeing the cessation of perception and feeling as empty.

Because it arises from great passion,
the left face is well held;
as the pure self of great delusion,
a face abides on the right.
To pacify the four māras
and to pacify all afflictions,
the two and two faces, right and left,
are to be known as black and contorted.
From great aversion, great delusion
and great passion as their origin,
the root face is to be known;
it abides in the manner of the nine moods.
As signifying space and nonduality,
the upper face is to be known.
Possessing the moods of the nine flavors:
graceful, heroic, frightful,
fierce, laughing and terrifying,
compassionate, awe-inspiring and peaceful:
these are called the moods of the nine flavors.
To abandon wrong livelihood
he slightly bares his fangs;
the wrathful, frowning, moving brows
are the abandoning of wrong views.

The three eyes are the three doors of liberation: emptiness, signlessness and wishlessness. Through this very sequence the eight faces and the twenty-four eyes come about. Moreover, because they pervade all sentient beings with great compassion, they are all red. Through his loving mind, the color of his body is black.

The emblems are the five Victors. Akṣobhya he bears on his head in the form of a wheel. Amitābha he holds in the form of earrings. Ratnasambhava abides as the jewel at his throat. Vairocana he holds in the form of bracelets. Amoghasiddhi he holds in the form of a girdle. The four māras, namely the māra of the aggregates, the māra of the afflictions, the māra of the Lord of Death, and the māra of the sons of the gods, he presses down with his feet in the forms of Brahmā, Indra, Upendra (Viṣṇu) and Rudra; the meaning is that they are the essential nature of attachment, aversion, delusion and envy. The garland of heads is the ten non-virtuous deeds that have been committed.

What are they? They are called killing, taking what is not given, sexual misconduct, lying, slander, anger, idle talk, covetousness, malice and wrong view. The armlets are the four bases of miraculous power, called aspiration, diligence, mindfulness and investigation. The anklets are the five transcendent aggregates: moral discipline, wisdom, meditative absorption, liberation, and the seeing of the wisdom of liberation.

To show the high and low of the root,
he stands in the dance of the half-crossed posture.
To abandon false attachment,
he has a seat of the net of yoginīs.
To abandon fear completely,
his body is covered with the dust of ashes.

To show that he has a form without essential nature, an existence without real entity, Nairātmyā embraces him at the neck. Her curved knife and skull cup are the essential nature of skillful means and wisdom. The emblems that rest in the eight skull cups of his right hands, the elephant and the rest, are, in order, disorders of the combined humors, fever, throat swelling, poison, stabbing pains, tumors, stomach disorders and contagion. The earth and the rest that rest in the eight skull cups on the left should be understood as, in order, attachment, aversion, delusion, slander, envy, haughtiness, pride and desire.

Having been empowered, all of them
attained unsurpassed wisdom,
and so they bear on their crowns
the holy guru Akṣobhya.
To bring forth the light of wisdom,
they shine brilliantly with a net of light.

This is the purification of the principal of the maṇḍala.

Now I shall state the purification of the goddesses. Gaurī is the essential nature of the aggregate of form. Caurī is the essential nature of the aggregate of feeling. Vetālī is the essential nature of the aggregate of perception. Ghasmarī is the essential nature of the aggregate of formations. Pukkasī is the essential nature of loving-kindness. Śavarī is the essential nature of compassion. Caṇḍālī is the essential nature of joy. Ḍombinī is the essential nature of equanimity.

The curved knife in Gaurī's right hand is what cuts off false conceptual thought. The rohita fish in her left is the mass of the habitual tendencies of saṃsāra. The hand drum in Caurī's right hand is what fully accomplishes skillful means and wisdom. The boar in her left is the essential nature of delusion. The tortoise in Vetālī's right hand is the nature of emptiness. The lotus vessel in her left is the essential nature of compassion. The snake in Ghasmarī's right hand is the very self of aversion. The yogic vessel in her left is the essential nature of skillful means and wisdom. The lion in Pukkasī's right hand terrifies the elephants of the host of Māra. The axe in her left means cutting down the tree of aversion. The monk in Śavarī's right hand is the accomplishing of the meditation on the five paths. The ringing staff in her left means accomplishing nondual wisdom. The wheel in Caṇḍālī's right hand means cutting off wrong views. The plough in her left means uprooting the affliction of ignorance. The vajra in Ḍombinī's right hand means realizing indivisible wisdom. The threatening forefinger of her left hand subdues the vicious.

The three eyes of all of these look upon the past, the future and the present time. The two arms are the nature of the two formless ones. What are the two formless ones? They are called space and consciousness. Attachment, aversion, delusion, slander, anger, envy, craving and pride are the seats, Brahmā and the rest. The five mudrās are the five views. What are they? The view of the transitory collection, wrong view, the view that holds to extremes, holding views as supreme, and holding moral discipline and ascetic conduct as supreme. In order to abandon the angry mind, their faces are contorted and their hair stands on end.

Now I shall state the purification of the maṇḍala. The union of body, speech and mind is the maṇḍala. It is four-sided in the manner of the aspects of the four truths. The four gates are conceived for the purpose of terrifying the four māras. The four corners are conceived as the essential nature of the four abodes of Brahmā. It is beautified by eight pillars, the essential nature of the eight consciousnesses. And what are those consciousnesses? Eye consciousness, and those of the ear, nose, tongue, body and mind, the afflicted mental consciousness, and the all-base consciousness. The eight vases are the eight forms. What are they? They are called earth, water, fire, wind, color, smell, taste and the tangible. The branches that adorn their mouths are the eightfold path. What are they? They are called right view, right understanding, right speech, right ends of action, right livelihood, right effort,

right mindfulness and right meditative absorption. The five jewels are the five powers: the power of faith, the power of diligence, the power of mindfulness, the power of meditative absorption and the power of wisdom. The full garlands of the maṇḍala mean the destruction of the afflictions called attachment, aversion, delusion and pride. The half garlands are the destruction of the secondary afflictions.

Through the distinction of entity and non-entity,
whatever mind is fully expanded,
that mind is called the canopy:
so it is taught in the ultimate sense.

The limbs of meditative absorption are the archways. What are they? Approach, close approach, accomplishment and great accomplishment. The victory banners are those very same. The wisdom of the eightfold path is the adornment with garlands of yak-tail whisks. The four seals of the Dharma are the possession of vajra lines. What are they? They are called: all defiled phenomena are suffering; all compounded things are impermanent; all phenomena are without self; nirvāṇa is peace. Loving-kindness, compassion and the rest are the flowers, incense, lamps and perfume. Just as with this inner maṇḍala, the same should be understood for the outer one as well.

Now I shall explain the charnel grounds.

By this reasoning, called the movement of the breath,
it is designated "charnel ground."

As this says, what is called the charnel ground is the body, that is, the earth element. Because it protects the field, the field protector (kṣetrapāla) is the wind. The nāga is that whose nature is burning and cooking. The tree is by way of the characteristic of space. The cloud is by way of the essential nature of water. Gain and loss, fame and disrepute, blame and praise, pleasure and pain and the rest are the world protectors. Disease and the rest are the hungry ghosts, the bhūtas, the piśācas and the rest. The eight charnel grounds are the eight limbs. In the center of these, by nature of supreme joy, the Blessed One dwells, surrounded by the yoginīs.

Dwelling within the ocean of saṃsāra, with its waves churned by all the faults of grasping at self and mine, and with its seizing sea monsters,
beings are blinded until the very end of their lives.
Whatever merit has arisen, without exception, from composing this Illumination of Reality,

by it, with the boat of reality, may all these worlds without exception always be ferried across.

The Means of Accomplishing Hevajra called Illumination of Reality, composed by the master paṇḍita Kṛṣṇapāda, is complete.

The great scholar of brahmin family,
who delights in benefiting the Buddha's teaching,
the one bearing the name Kṛṣṇa, together with
the monk Tsultrim Gyalwa, translated it.
Whatever virtue has been gained from this,
by it may beings, all without exception,
realize the two stages and the four mudrās
and attain the state of Vajradhara.

Translator's Notes

• Samayavajra in the second homage verse is taken as the name of the author's guru; it could also be read as an epithet, "the vajra of the pledge." Repha is the Sanskrit name of the letter ra, the seed of the sun disc. The final sentence is terse; it is read as saying that the meditator, set within the elemental maṇḍalas, abides as the ground for the distinctive transcendent wisdom about to be generated.
• Several names are rendered by meaning because their Sanskrit forms could not be fixed with confidence from this Tibetan: the first four charnel grounds (Fierce and Violent, the Dense, Garland of Flames, the Terrifying One with Skulls), the Forest of the Lord, the eight lords of the clouds, and the names of the field protectors. The tree names are given as the text spells them; the verse list (with kaṅkeli and aśva) and the prose list (with aśvaka and the bodhi tree) do not match exactly. The line on the lute goddess (pi wang bsgying ma) is uncertain. In the list of charnel-ground sights, ba glang gi tshe is read as carcasses of oxen; tshe is unclear. The deity at the close of the fivefold awakening is named Vajrasattva in the Tibetan.
• "Twice-drinker" renders the Tibetan calque of Sanskrit dvipa, a standard poetic name for the elephant, marking the first of the animals in the right-hand skull cups. Śavarī renders ri khrod ma, "the mountain woman," one of the eight goddesses of the retinue. The nine moods of dance are the classical rasas of Indian aesthetics.
• The text says only "the maṇḍala arisen from the syllable yaṃ"; yaṃ is the seed of the wind maṇḍala, so "wind" is supplied. The Eight-Faced One is Hevajra himself, whose mantra expels the obstructors.
• The text announces sixteen emptinesses as the sixteen arms but in fact lists eighteen; the list is translated as it stands. In the second aspiration verse, "the fluid of the queen" translates btsun mo'i khu ba, referring to the consort's fluid shared as sacramental food in the tantric feast. In the dedication verse the Tibetan leaves the subject unstated, so it is rendered impersonally.
• "Five paths": the Tibetan reads lan rnam pa lnga ("five kinds of answer/times"), which makes no sense here; translated as lam ("path"), an evident scribal slip. "Stomach disorders" renders pho sran, a term of uncertain meaning. The text's own lists diverge from the standard ones

(anger in place of harsh speech among the ten non-virtues, mindfulness in place of mind among the bases of miraculous power, rtogs pa "understanding" for right intention); these are translated as written. "The high and low of the root" (rtsa ba) is obscure; rtsa may also mean the subtle channels.
• "Seizing sea monsters" renders 'dzin khri, an unusual expression; it appears to mean the grasping water monsters (makaras) of the ocean of saṃsāra. The author's name nag po'i zhabs is given as Kṛṣṇapāda (also known as Kāṇha); the co-translator Kṛṣṇa is a different person, a brahmin paṇḍita.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.